MVPCompanion

RESOURCE 3.2

The MVP Scope Challenge

A practical worksheet to decide what belongs in the MVP—and what does not.

PURPOSE

Use this worksheet after identifying the primary user, value proposition, and Core Jobs. Challenge every proposed capability against the user outcome and the learning goal. The aim is the smallest coherent MVP that can deliver meaningful value and test important assumptions.

1. Define the MVP promise

Primary user and situation

Outcome the MVP must help the user achieve

Core Jobs the MVP must support

What must the MVP teach us? (learning question)

2. List the capabilities you are considering

List capabilities—not just screen names. Keep each item small enough to challenge.
Use one row per capability and refer to its ID on the next pages.

C1		
C2		
C3		
C4		

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Challenge Each Capability

Use the questions to test whether a capability is essential, merely useful, or out of scope.

For each capability, ask: Which Core Job does it support? What happens if it is removed? Is it needed for first value or for learning?

CAPABILITY C1

Why is it needed?

If removed, what breaks?

Job link / evidence / learning contribution

CAPABILITY C2

Why is it needed?

If removed, what breaks?

Job link / evidence / learning contribution

CAPABILITY C3

Why is it needed?

If removed, what breaks?

Job link / evidence / learning contribution

CAPABILITY C4

Why is it needed?

If removed, what breaks?

Job link / evidence / learning contribution

Classify and Reduce Scope

Make explicit decisions. Avoid keeping a capability just because it has already been discussed.

Classify each capability based on the current evidence. “Must Have” means the MVP cannot deliver its core outcome or run the critical learning test without it.

C1 — DECISION

Scope category Select...

Confidence Select...

Rationale / evidence

C2 — DECISION

Scope category Select...

Confidence Select...

Rationale / evidence

C3 — DECISION

Scope category Select...

Confidence Select...

Rationale / evidence

C4 — DECISION

Scope category Select...

Confidence Select...

Rationale / evidence

Dependencies and end-to-end coherence

Dependencies: what must exist for the core journey to work?

Can a user complete the core journey from start to meaningful outcome?

What can be removed without undermining value or learning?

Set the MVP Boundary

Record the smallest coherent scope, explicit exclusions, and the next validation step.

3. Final scope decision

Must Have: the minimum capabilities required for core value and learning

Should Have: useful, but not required for first value or the first learning cycle

Later: valuable capabilities deliberately deferred

Not in MVP: explicit exclusions and why

4. Boundary statement and review

MVP boundary: “The MVP enables [user] to [outcome] by supporting [Core Jobs] through [minimum capabilities].”

Largest remaining assumption or risk

Next test / validation action, owner, and date

Decision rule: scope is justified by user value, Core Jobs, and learning—not by feature popularity.